**Syria Narrative Tracker** www.syrianpulse.org

Daily reports · 13 November 2026

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Syria Narrative Tracker · as of the last update, 13 November 2026, 20:29 UTC

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## 1. The day at a glance

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**Weary** Outlets focused heavily on diplomacy (Qatar-Turkey statement, Shaibani's Gulf meetings) and the reversal of the US visa restriction, while public commenters reacted more to everyday grievances: electricity rationing, fuel prices, Israeli incursions in Quneitra, and recurring accountability protests in Aleppo. Kurdish-language outlets and public voices focused on the Rojava Film Festival, Shengal anniversary, and north-east integration concerns, distinct from Arabic-language conversation. Sentiment is mixed: hopeful about diplomatic normalization and reconstruction, but weary and angry over power cuts, heating costs, and unresolved justice issues.

## 2. What people said

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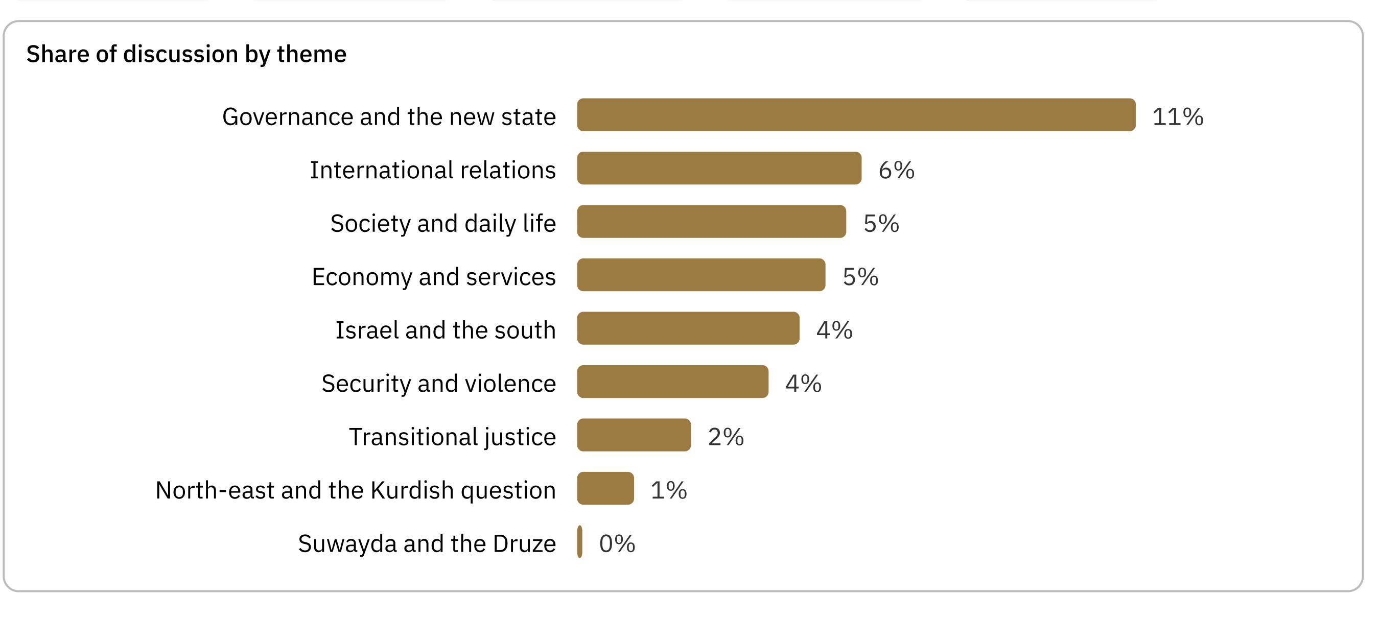
### The day in numbers

| Leaning negative | Mostly neutral | 18 | 3,313 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| People's tone | Outlets' tone | stories followed | post analyses | updates |


Share of discussion by theme

### The day's stories

1. **Crackdown on 'Low-Quality Content' Creators Sparks Debate** Society and daily life · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: mostly neutral · 14% of the discussion
   A government campaign targeting creators of 'low-quality' livestream content has sparked public debate over morality policing versus free expression. Syria TV questioned who decides content classification and how to prevent it from becoming opinion censorship. Commenters are split between support for the crackdown on moral grounds and mockery of selective enforcement.
2. **Protests Demand Accountability for Former Regime Figures Across Syria** Transitional justice · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 9% of the discussion
   Protests continued in Aleppo's Saadallah al-Jabiri Square demanding accountability for former regime figures, intensified after Raqqa Governor Abdulrahman Salama's remarks about Liwa al-Baqir commander Khaled al-Mar'i. Hama's Wadi al-Jawz residents separately protested over land expropriation. Public comments are deeply divided between calls for justice and warnings against reopening wounds.
3. **Syria Recovers Ilyushin Aircraft Stranded in Libya Since Assad's Fall** Governance and the new state · People: leaning negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 9% of the discussion
   Syria recovered a military Ilyushin aircraft that had been stranded at Benina airport in Benghazi since Assad's fall, the second aircraft returned to the fleet. Sawt al-Asima sources link the plane to past transport of officers from the Fourth Division, Republican Guard and National Security Bureau.
4. **Shaibani Meets Gulf, Egyptian and Iraqi Counterparts at Sir Bani Yas Forum** International relations · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: leaning positive · 8% of the discussion
   Foreign Minister Asaad al-Shaibani held meetings with counterparts from the UAE, Egypt, Iraq and Bahrain at the Sir Bani Yas Forum in Abu Dhabi on 13 November. Egypt reaffirmed support for Syria's unity and sovereignty. Separately, Qatar and Turkey issued a joint statement backing Syria's stability and condemning Israeli violations, alongside signing a mutual defense pact.
5. **Car Dealership Owner Accused of Fleeing with Customers' Money in Damascus** Economy and services · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 7% of the discussion
   A Damascus car dealership owner is accused of disappearing with customers' advance payments for vehicles, sparking widespread discussion. Outlets report the case fueled a broader debate about the risks of prepaying unlicensed dealerships versus authorized agencies.
6. **Syria Imposes Then Reverses US/UK Entry Restrictions** Governance and the new state · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: mostly neutral · 6% of the discussion
   Syria's Foreign Ministry lifted the prior entry approval requirement for US and British citizens on 13 November, days after introducing it, following public backlash over harm to tourism. Officials said entry procedures reverted to previous rules while other nationalities remain unaffected. Commenters and aggregators widely framed the episode as a reversal after 'uproar'.
7. **Israeli Incursions and Detentions Continue in Quneitra and Daraa** Israel and the south · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 6% of the discussion
   Israeli forces raided homes in Jbata al-Khashab in northern Quneitra countryside on 13 November, part of ongoing incursions. Families of over 40 detainees held in Israeli prisons protested near the UNDOF post at Nabaa al-Fawwar, demanding Syrian and international action. A possible Israel-Damascus security deal under Eisenkot is also being discussed.
8. **Rojava Film Festival Opens, Shengal Liberation Anniversary Marked** North-east and the Kurdish question · People: strongly positive · Outlets: leaning positive · 4% of the discussion
   The sixth Rojava International Film Festival opened in Qamishli on 13 November, paying tribute to victims of the 1960 Amuda cinema massacre. Separately, the Yazidi Women's Union in Rojava marked the anniversary of Shengal's liberation from ISIS. Kurdish-language public posts expressed pride and solidarity around both events.
9. **Fatal Fuel Tanker Collision and Fire on Homs-Tartus Road** Security and violence · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 3% of the discussion
   A fuel tanker collided and caught fire on the Homs-Tartus road near Haithamiya, killing three people, according to Civil Defense. Civil Defense retrieved three charred bodies, reopened the road, and the incident fueled renewed criticism of unsafe tanker transport and poor road infrastructure.
10. **Electricity Rationing Worsens as Winter Approaches** Economy and services · People: strongly negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 3% of the discussion
    The Syrian Electricity Company said increased rationing hours nationwide stem from the Tishreen plant going offline, fuel and Azerbaijani gas shortages, rising global fuel prices, and maintenance work. Officials cite illegal power tapping and rising winter consumption as compounding factors. Public anger grows over diesel shortages and cold weather in Quneitra and elsewhere.
11. **Unknown Gunmen Kill Soldier, Wound Two in Eastern Deir ez-Zor** Security and violence · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 2% of the discussion
    Unidentified gunmen killed a Syrian army soldier and wounded two others in an attack in Jadeedat Bakkara, eastern Deir ez-Zor, on 13 November, the Defense Ministry said. North Press and SANA reported the incident, with public commenters expressing grief and recurring frustration at insecurity in the region.
12. **Defense Minister Meets US and French Military Delegations** International relations · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: mostly neutral · 2% of the discussion
    Syrian Defense Minister Murhaf Abu Qasra met a US military delegation led by Adm. Liam Hulin of the Combined Joint Task Force for Operation Inherent Resolve, alongside separate talks with French officials in Damascus. The meetings discussed regional coordination between Damascus and Washington.
13. **Lebanon Requests Extradition of Two Syrians in Killing of Former Iraqi MP** International relations · People: leaning negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 2% of the discussion
    Lebanese authorities asked Damascus on 13 November to arrest and extradite two Syrian nationals suspected in the killing of former Iraqi MP Ahmed al-Alwani in Beirut. Investigators are examining whether the killing was premeditated, with the motive still unclear. Public commentary speculated about political connections to Syria's government.
14. **Security Forces Dismantle ISIS Cell in Aleppo, Free Hostage** Security and violence · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: leaning positive · 2% of the discussion
    Syrian General Intelligence and Internal Security Forces dismantled an ISIS cell in Aleppo involved in attacks and assassinations, arresting four members, one wounded in a clash, and freeing a hostage held for ransom. Officials seized weapons, explosives and ammunition.
15. **EU Weighs Broad Upgrade of Ties with Syria** International relations · People: mostly neutral · Outlets: leaning positive · 2% of the discussion
    The EU is preparing a Syria Partnership Coordination Forum in Damascus, co-chaired by Foreign Minister Asaad al-Shaibani and EU Commissioner Dubravka Suica, to discuss investment, security sector reform and reviving a 2008 association agreement, with a possible business conference in 2027.
16. **Kurdish Rights, Women's Councils and Integration Concerns in the North-East** North-east and the Kurdish question · People: leaning negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 2% of the discussion
    Debate continues over the integration of north-east Syria into the Syrian state, with an Afrin lawmaker relaying urgent demands to President al-Sharaa on missing persons, detainees and property rights, and Syria Direct reporting that Kurdish women's councils and the co-presidency system have been dissolved.
17. **Third Polio Case Confirmed in Mayadin, Deir ez-Zor** Society and daily life · Outlets: mostly neutral · 1% of the discussion
    Syria's Health Ministry confirmed a third polio case in Mayadin, Deir ez-Zor, linked to the two previous cases in the same area. Vaccination campaigns have been launched and expanded as part of the response, while Lebanon raised its own preparedness after Syria's cases.
18. **Government Forces and National Guard Exchange Fire in Rural Suwayda** Suwayda and the Druze · Outlets: leaning negative · 1% of the discussion
    Government security forces and the 'National Guard' exchanged fire in rural Suwayda, amid conflicting accounts, continuing tensions over who holds security authority in the Druze-majority province. A separate OCHA meeting addressed humanitarian response plans there.

## 3. What the media said

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### Oil, Diplomacy and Winter Cold Dominate Coverage

**In short:** Media coverage on November 13 centred on Syria's expanding economic ties, from Iraqi oil transiting to Baniyas to renewed foreign representation, while security reporting focused on Israeli incursions in Quneitra and the Mihrac Ural arrest fallout. Governance stories highlighted the reversal of new US/UK visa restrictions after public backlash, alongside protests demanding accountability. Economic reporting also dwelt heavily on the winter heating crisis gripping Syrian households.

#### Security

Syria TV reported new developments in the arrest of Mihrac Ural (Ali Kayali), noting Lebanon detained a suspect linked to the operation. Several outlets, including Syria TV, Al Jazeera, Asharq Al-Awsat and Naharnet, covered Lebanon's request to Syria to extradite suspects in the killing of former Iraqi MP Ahmed al-Alwani in Beirut. Israeli Defence Minister Katz was quoted by North Press, Syria TV and Asharq Al-Awsat saying Israel does not need opposition or court approval to direct military operations in the region, while Enab Baladi reported he insists on maintaining a 'security zone' in Syria. Enab Baladi and Syria TV reported Israeli forces released two young men in Quneitra while continuing incursions and searches, and SANA said Israeli forces detained three people in Jabata al-Khashab. North Press and Anadolu Agency reported three Syrian army personnel were killed or wounded in an unclaimed attack in Deir ez-Zor, with Enab Baladi giving similar figures. Coverage of a possible Syrian troop deployment to Yemen appeared in Syria TV, RFI, and Anadolu Agency and TRT World, which both cited a Yemeni official denying such reports reflect current reality, while the Turkish state-run Anadolu Agency also reported 52 ceasefire violations on its fourth day.

#### Economy

Reuters, Syria TV and Enab Baladi reported Iraq now exports about 150,000 barrels of oil daily overland through Syria to Baniyas port as an alternative to the Strait of Hormuz, with TASS and IRNA also covering the route's revival and Syria TV citing a cumulative 1.6 million barrels since the agreement began. Al-Watan Online quoted an academic saying the era of sanctions has ended but the era of financing has not yet begun, stressing trust must come first, while Al-Modon reported growing international momentum to support development and financing in Syria. Heating and fuel shortages dominated Syrian outlets: Hawar News, affiliated with the Kurdish-led administration, reported rising prices narrowing heating options, while Syria TV described firewood, diesel and pistachio shells being used amid a chronic crisis, and SANA and Syria TV reported the start of subsidized heating diesel deliveries. SANA cited the Syrian Electricity Company explaining increased rationing hours, and Syria TV found thermal plants have large capacity but limited output. Independent Arabia reported Syria's citrus sector struggling with weak marketing despite abundant production.

#### Governance

Multiple outlets, including Al-Monitor, The New Arab and the Turkish state-run Anadolu Agency, reported Syria rolled back new visa restrictions on US and UK citizens after public backlash over fears it would harm tourism; Al-Quds Al-Arabi and Asharq Al-Awsat also covered the reversal. Halab Today and North Press reported Syria regained full membership in the Euro-Mediterranean Postal Union after a 15-year suspension. Syria TV and SANA reported ambassador Hussein al-Sabbagh presented credentials as Syria's permanent delegate to the FAO. SANA and Syria TV reported Qatar and Turkey renewed support for Syria's stability and called for an end to Israeli violations, while Asharq Al-Awsat reported Erdogan asked al-Sharaa about Syria's situation at COP31. Enab Baladi and Enab Baladi reported a demonstration in Aleppo demanding accountability for 'criminals' of the former regime. Enab Baladi and Enab Baladi reported access to information sparking a debate between media and government in Damascus. Al-Modon analysed the persistence of a 'deep state' beyond the fall of regime loyalists, and Al-Modon reported plans to relocate ministries outside Damascus and lease land to Turkey for a hundred years. L'Orient-Le Jour noted Syria's political life still awaits a law on political parties. The Atlantic Council argued Atlantic Council Syria should not join the Mecca Alliance but cooperate with it.

#### How they compare

Ordinary Syrians' top concerns differed sharply from the media agenda: the largest share of posts, up to 19%, debated a crackdown on 'low-quality content' creators and a proposed morals law, a story largely absent from the media items reviewed. People also mocked the recovery of an Ilyushin aircraft stranded in Libya, a story the media barely touched, and discussed a Damascus car dealership owner accused of fleeing with customers' money, which the media did not cover at all. Where the media and the public overlapped, such as the visa reversal for Americans and the Aleppo accountability protests, Syrians' tone was more mixed and skeptical than the comparatively neutral media framing. The heating crisis, covered extensively by outlets like Syria TV and Hawar News, drew far angrier reactions among ordinary Syrians, who expressed direct anger at the presidency over unresolved shortages. Posts about Israeli detentions and incursions in Quneitra, also covered by Enab Baladi, carried a notably negative public tone, reflecting frustration with both Israeli actions and perceived state inaction.

→ Full page with sources

## 4. Sources and method

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### Reports and articles drawn on (39)

- Syria TV: اعتقال معراج أورال.. مستجدات تكشف خيوط العملية ولبنان يوقف مشتبه بمشاركتهم فيها
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- Syria TV: الاحتلال الإسرائيلي ينصب حاجزاً عسكرياً في ريف القنيطرة الأوسط ويفتش المارة
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- North Press: North press agency – فقدان وإصابة 3 عناصر من الجيش السوري باستهداف مجهولين
- Enab Baladi: مجهولون يقتلون عنصرًا من الجيش ويصيبون آخرين بدير الزور
- Syria TV: هل ستتورط سوريا بحرب استنزاف في اليمن؟
- Reuters: EXCLUSIVE: Iraq turns to trucks to export oil in overland Syrian route revival
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- Syria TV: كاتس: لا نحتاج موافقة المعارضة لتنفيذ عمليات عسكرية في سوريا وغزة ولبنان
- Enab Baladi: نحو 150 ألف برميل من النفط العراقي إلى بانياس السورية يوميًا
- Syria TV: منذ بدء الاتفاق.. العراق صدّر 1.6 مليون برميل نفط عبر سوريا
- Al-Watan Online: انتهى زمن العقوبات ولم يبدأ زمن التمويل.. أكاديمي لـ”الوطن”: الثقة أولاً
- المدن: برنية: حراك دولي متنامٍ لدعم التنمية والتمويل في سوريا
- Hawar News: "دفء بثمن مرتفع".. الأسعار تضيق خيارات الأسر السورية مع دخول الشتاء
- Syria TV: حطب ومازوت وقشر فستق.. لماذا تعاني سوريا من أزمة تدفئة مزمنة؟
- سانا: Syria begins delivering subsidized heating diesel to provinces
- Syria TV: الشركة السورية للبترول توضح آلية توريد مازوت التدفئة المدعوم وتوزيعه
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- Naharnet: Lebanon asks Syria to arrest two who fled after killing Alwani
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- Halab Today: سوريا تستعيد عضويتها الكاملة في الاتحاد البريدي الأورومتوسطي بعد 15 عامًا
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- Syria TV: سوريا تعزز تمثيلها لدى "الفاو".. حسين الصباغ يقدم أوراق اعتماده مندوباً دائماً
- SANA: قطر وتركيا تجددان دعمهما استقرار سوريا وتدعوان لوقف الانتهاكات الإسرائيلية
- Syria TV: تركيا وقطر تؤكدان دعم استقرار سوريا وضرورة إلزام إسرائيل باتفاقية فض الاشتباك
- Enab Baladi: حلب.. مظاهرة تطالب بمحاسبة “المجرمين” وتحقيق العدالة
- Enab Baladi: Aleppo Protesters Demand Accountability and Justice - Enab Baladi
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- Enab Baladi: Information Access Sparks Media-Government Debate in Damascus - Enab Baladi
- المدن: بعد "الفلول": الدولة العميقة في سوريا!
- المدن: سوريا: نقل وزارات خارج دمشق.. وتأجير أراضٍ لتركيا لمئة عام
- L'Orient-Le Jour: En Syrie, la vie politique attend encore une loi sur les partis
- Atlantic Council: Syria shouldn’t join the Mecca Alliance. It should cooperate with it.

Written automatically by an AI model from the titles and short summaries of the reports, which are linked. It describes what the sources say, not what is true. From Syrian outlets only investigations, in-depth reports, analysis and official statements are used, and paywalled outlets are missing: this is not the whole picture.

Analysis generated automatically by an AI model from public posts. It describes what is being said, not what is true. Individuals are never named, quoted or linked.

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